

OKS newsletter



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Facebook page link [Otago Kidney Whānau | Facebook](#)

Welcome to the Otago Kidney Society (OKS) Spring 2026 newsletter



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Message from the Committee

Welcome to the Spring a mixed bag of weather over winter with some lovely days with a few frosts and snow, as my Mum would say the worst weather comes after the shortest day.

Winter has been quiet with the Otago Kidney Society with our winter lunch cancelled due to the rising cost of fuel.

If you want a visit or some help please don't hesitate to get in touch with us, email info@oks.nz or ph 027 454 3512.

I was lucky enough to be asked to talk to the Care Coordinators in our area and they were very keen to know about our community and how they could be of help to our members. They are there to support people with Chronic illness. As the *pamphlet below* states you can refer yourself and a needs assessment will be carried out. If you are interested in getting some help and want some help please let me know (Natalie) and I can arrange for someone to contact you.

Also in the newsletter is some information regarding the new Dunedin Hospital Outpatients building.

We are looking forward to our Christmas lunch 12 midday at The Post Office, Clyde 6th December.

Our website is not too far away here is a little tease, looking forward to have it up and running soon.

Need to talk? Email info@oks.nz or phone 027 454 3512 — we're a friendly volunteer group based in Dunedin.



Otago Kidney Society
INC. — DUNEDIN, NEW ZEALAND

Home

About

Support

Events

Newsletters

Donate

Co

Many thanks, OKS Committee

HOME as my FIRST CHOICE

Ki te whare tōku whiriwhiri tuatahi

We are committed to the *Home as My First Choice* programme which aims to help you, or members of your family, maintain health and independence.

The Health New Zealand website has a useful page – search “Support for older people in Otago and Southland Health NZ”

This page includes information and videos about Home as my First Choice and the Care Coordination Centre.

It also includes a useful booklet called ‘Home as my First Choice Community Resources’ which details a range of support services available for adults of all ages seeking ways to maintain health and independence in their community and their home. The booklet can be printed, downloaded or viewed online.

Health NZ | Te Whatu Ora Southern is committed to helping you, or members of your family/whānau, maintain health and independence in your community and home. Support services are arranged by Health NZ Southern's Care Coordination Centre (CCC).

How does the Care Coordination Centre work?

Your doctor, the hospital treating you or another health professional, will send a referral to the CCC. You may refer yourself. Providing your referral meets the eligibility criteria for services, the CCC will arrange support for you. This may be short term or long term. If you have been referred for long term support, you will also receive a comprehensive needs based assessment.

What is a needs-based assessment?

After you have been referred for assessment, you, or your nominated person, will be contacted by either a Health NZ Southern staff member or a Home and Community Support Service (HCSS) Provider (Access Community Health, Healthcare New Zealand, Royal District Nursing Service NZ).

An assessment can take up to two hours. The assessments are an opportunity to discuss with you and your family/whānau the level of support needed and identify any urgent needs.

You are encouraged to have a family/whānau member present with you during the assessment if you wish, to support

Health New Zealand Te Whatu Ora



Care Coordination Centre
Private Bag 1921, Dunedin
Phone: 0800 627 236

you with meeting your health needs and help you achieve your goals.

What happens during the assessment?

The assessments are carried out by either a Health NZ Southern Clinical Needs Assessor (CNA) or a HCSS Registered Health Professional (RHP), who are qualified health professionals. They will use a laptop computer during the assessment to record information. CNAs and RHPs will work with you and your family/whānau to identify your health needs and your goals.

Your goals will be personal and individual to you and could include help with tasks at home such as; showering and dressing, being able to prepare a meal. Or community-based activities such as; being able to regularly attend a social group, grocery shopping, getting to the library or improving mobility. Your CNA or RHP will ensure your Support (care) Workers have the training they need to help you.

What happens next?

After the assessment the CNA or RHP will arrange the services you need to help you achieve your health and independence goals. You will be advised as to what services will be provided.

There will be ongoing reviews of your care plan to make sure it is appropriately supporting you to live self-sufficiently and enjoy life.

Health New Zealand Te Whatu Ora

Care Coordination Centre

Supporting you to live
independently



What support services are available?

Support services are available to people who need assistance to live as independently as possible in their own home. This may be short or long term.

Residential care and palliative support services are also available for those who meet the criteria for this level of care. This will be discussed with you at the time of your assessment.

These services are available to anyone living in the Health NZ Southern district.

These are some of the health services Health NZ Southern can coordinate:

- Personal assistance and home management
- Carer support
- Respite care
- Community activities
- Meals on Wheels
- Residential care

There are other Health NZ Southern services that are available to support you. These include Community Nursing, Social Work, Adaptive Equipment and Rehabilitation Services.

See <https://www.healthnz.govt.nz/hospitals-services/hospitals/otago-southland> for a wide range of community services also available.

Southland Kidney Society Inc

Hi guys
Update from Southland:

1. Our new dialysis unit at Southland Hospital is far superior to the previous unit that could only deal with 3 patients per week. Due to a new unit with 5 chairs, double shift staffing and a 50% Nephrologist - they can now dialysis 20 patients per week. This resulted from persistent lobbying of local MPs and Minister Simeon Brown.

2. We are also looking to support the unit in a different way - providing a new coffee machine like Dunedin Hospital for staff and patient supporters.

3. We also intend to provide 4 tablets with reusable head phones, so those undertaking their dialysis can do so while watching movies and documentaries on Netflix - we have funding support for the tablets / head phones (\$2500 for 4 sets) - while we will fund the Netflix option for a 4-option package (each user can select differently) - about \$400 for the package per year via the patient wifi system at the hospital.

4. We also wish to lobby key MPs for a greater awareness and benefits of live and cadaver donors - using TV and online awareness. Possibly a opt out system (as opposed to opt in) - where unless the individual or family decline, harvesting donation will be assumed. Also greater paid leave for live donors including non-directed donors.

**Regards
Nobby Clark**

New Dunedin Hospital Build Outpatients



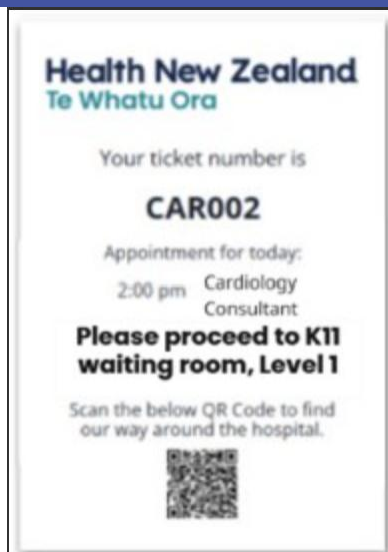
It is not too long now until the New Dunedin Hospital Outpatients will be open the link below is to webpage for the new hospital build, if you have any questions don't hesitate to contact me (Natalie) and I will try and help.

[New Dunedin Hospital | Project Whakatuputupu](#)

The building will be named K along with the Te Reo name and the entry is 360 Cumberland Street.

You will login at a kiosk or at reception on the ground floor with your barcode that is on your appointment letter.





After logging in you will be given a ticket (a sample on the left) with your meeting room code, It will have your waiting room number K11 is Building K, level one and K11 being the waiting area for your clinic.

In your waiting room there will be a screen that will show you're your ticket number CAR002 and how long you have to wait for your appointment.

If you are unsure how to scan your barcode you can enter your details (first name, last name and date of birth) manually at the kiosk. You will be asked if you have changed your GP, you will then be asked if you have another appointment to check into.

The kiosk checks you in but can also give you directions to your waiting area see screen shot from kiosk below.

Health New Zealand
Te Whatu Ora

English Help

Kia Ora

Welcome to Dunedin Hospital Outpatient Building



The privacy policy can be located at <https://www.healthnz.govt.nz/privacy/privacy-statement>



Christchurch Kidney Society Update

- There really hasn't been much happening here - just getting through winter! Some of the highlights were:
- Nancy (our dialysis treatment van) has been on five hires since Christmas and crossed 'the ditch' twice during that time.
- Jayco Canterbury have fitted a smart TV in Nancy and we will have wifi available for users.
- Rosie, our new fundraising and marketing coordinator, has scheduled a quiz night at the Christchurch Casino for Sunday 4th October.
- We had an amazing response to our call for help with 'beanies and gloves' and have all our people on dialysis in the hospital snug!
- Sadly last week one of our loved Committee members, Alae Tuu'u, passed away, so it has been such a sad time.
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Thanks so much

Jo Houghton

Field Officer / Manager

CHRISTCHURCH KIDNEY SOCIETY INC.

Serving our renal community for over 45 years

1/10 Yukon Place, Hornby, Christchurch 8042

Ph: 03 341 0906 or 021 2860 309

Southern Dialysis Service Update

Spring 2026

It's hard to believe I'm being asked for an update for the Spring newsletter- with the snowfall we experienced last week it certainly still feels as though we're in the depths of winter!

Despite the cold weather things across the Southern Dialysis Service remain exceptionally busy as we have seen a significant increase in the number of patients starting haemodialysis this year. Historically the service would expect around 15 new haemodialysis starts annually. However, in the first six months of 2026 alone, we have already had 11 people commence haemodialysis, placing us on track to significantly exceed previous years' demand.

This growth is creating capacity challenges across both Dunedin and Invercargill and our teams are working hard to maximise the utilisation of existing dialysis chairs while continuing to advocate for additional dialysis space to meet the growing needs of our communities.

In Dunedin we are pleased to be nearing completion of a dedicated medication room. This has been a long-awaited improvement as previously we did not have a dedicated space for medication preparation and storage. This new space will provide a safer and more efficient working environment for staff and patients alike.

Staffing has also seen some positive developments. The Invercargill Satellite Unit is now fully recruited however, current staffing levels still only allow us to safely operate two shifts across three days each week, meaning we are not yet able to utilise the available space to its full capacity. Expanding service capacity remains a key priority, and we continue to advocate for the additional resources required to meet increasing patient demand.

Looking ahead, we are delighted to welcome a Supported First Year of Practice (SFYP) Registered Nurse to the Dunedin unit in August. Investing in the next generation of dialysis nurses is essential for the future of our service, and we are excited to support and mentor new talent entering this highly specialised area of nursing.

There is also a significant amount of work occurring nationally around dialysis access and equity. We are hopeful that these discussions will lead to meaningful improvements in service delivery and help to ensure better and more equitable access to dialysis for all New Zealanders. We are also advocating for increased support from allied health services, recognising the vital role multidisciplinary teams play in delivering high-quality patient care. As always, thank you to the Otago Kidney Society for your ongoing support. Your contribution helps ensure we can continue to provide excellent care to our patients, even as demand continues to grow.



**Ngā mihi
Nic**

**Nic Holborow
Charge Nurse Manager
Southern Dialysis Service
+64 027 665 6659 | nic.holborow@southerndhb.govt.nz
Private Bag 1921 | Dunedin 9054**

Kidney Health

New Zealand Tākihi Hauora Aotearoa

Kia ora koutou,

Where has the year gone? Christmas feels like it is fast approaching, which means all of us here at Kidney Health New Zealand are getting ready for our busy summer testing season. However, before we start getting too excited about the promise of warmer weather, let's touch on what has been happening since KHNZ's last update.

I am delighted to share the outcome of Pharmac's consultation on widening access to certain medications, including Empagliflozin (Jardiance). Following significant feedback, Pharmac extended the consultation period for a further two weeks - and ultimately made the decision to widen the access criteria. Under the new criteria anyone with type 2 diabetes whose blood sugar levels remain high, despite treatment with other funded diabetes medicines, will gain access. These changes will allow an estimated 45,000 previously ineligible New Zealanders to access Empagliflozin over the next five years alone. We wish to thank those of you who supported our submission or made your own.

Currently, we also have two new opportunities available on our website's Research Hub – the JUNIPER Study of New Zealand Clinical Research and the University of Sydney's 'Health Behaviours and Substance Use in People With CKD' study. These provide valuable opportunities to help shape the

future of kidney disease treatment in New Zealand. We are hoping to increase the number of studies available to you as we strengthen our ability to act as a link between patients and researchers in the future. If you would like more information on these studies and to see whether you are eligible, please visit: <https://www.kidney.health.nz/patient-support/research-hub>.

We are proud to advocate for better outcomes for those with kidney disease in New Zealand, and it is lovely to see some positivity coming from the renal space. As we move into the latter half of 2026, early detection and education remain key focuses for KHNZ. If you would like us to provide testing or education sessions for you or your group, please reach out and let us know at info@kidney.health.nz.

Ngā mihi nui,

Madi Keay